# The Draugr of Barrowmuir

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at https://archiveofourown.org/works/95195366.

**Rating:**
Mature

**Archive Warning:**
Graphic Depictions Of Violence

**Category:**
Gen

**Fandom:**
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

**Characters:**
Hordak (She-Ra), Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), King Scorpio (She-Ra), Horde Soldiers (She-Ra)

**Additional Tags:**
Action/Adventure, Hordak's backstory, Scorpion Kingdom, Horror, Halloween

**Language:**
English

**Series:**
Part 7 of Tales of Terror for Cowering Cadets by Old Mother Weaver, Part 2 of Light-Bringer

**Stats:**
Published: 2026-10-23 Words: 4,559 Chapters: 1/2

# The Draugr of Barrowmuir

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at https://archiveofourown.org/works/95195366.

**Rating:**
Mature

**Archive Warning:**
Graphic Depictions Of Violence

**Category:**
Gen

**Fandom:**
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

**Characters:**
Hordak (She-Ra), Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), King Scorpio (She-Ra), Horde Soldiers (She-Ra)

**Additional Tags:**
Action/Adventure, Hordak's backstory, Scorpion Kingdom, Horror, Halloween

**Language:**
English

**Series:**
Part 7 of Tales of Terror for Cowering Cadets by Old Mother Weaver, Part 2 of Light-Bringer

**Stats:**
Published: 2026-10-23 Words: 4,559 Chapters: 1/2

# The Draugr of Barrowmuir

by KuuraKaihomieli


Summary

Shadow Weaver tells a tale of madness and mayhem to a gaggle of cadets during one stormy autumn night. Written for Bereaved Buckle's Halloween event; thank you for organizing it!

In the days of yore, the King of the Scorpion Kingdom beheld a peculiar omen in the heavens, a lurid red trail leading towards the uninhabited eastern moorlands. They were said to be haunted by the ancient rime-wights, who guarded their burial mounds with possessive frenzy. Should anyone disturb their peace, even their kith and kin would become forever doomed.

Around the same time, peasants in the borderlands began whispering of a draugr on the loose--a man-eating corpse risen from a burial mound to sate its unquenchable hunger on them...


Notes

This fic was inspired by a French legend about the beast of Gévaudan, and a play I saw in Stratford-upon-Avon back in August: Game of Thrones: The Mad King, plus my travels in Scotland and Romania. The story's wedged into my own longfic universe betwixt the Voidsword and Portal Experiments, however doesn't require prior knowledge of anything.

The storyline has lurked in the back of my mind for years, and I didn't think I'd ever write it. 'Twas a wee bit arduous to squeeze into two chapters!

See the end of the work for more notes

# Chapter 1

"When the wide welkins bleed

A sanguine savior shall arise

Bane and boon, reaper raw

Donning the demeanor of Death.

Glare-glows his grim glower

As he thy kingdom glorifies

Conqueror, condemner

Storm-scourge of the Scorpioni."

*-An unnamed soothsayer in King Scorpio's court*

Wind howled akin to a pack of voracious direwolves, chasing debris through narrow alleyways, buffeting and clattering whatever erred on its way. Clouds skittered across the dome of the sky, occasionally revealing two moons that had risen to witness the tempest. In the gloom they loomed upon the Fright Zone, doomed to room the starless heavens of Despondos. One a full orb during this nimbose night, one a sickle so sharp it might have schemed to slash the other in half to splatter the lands below with astronomic guts.

The realm of Warlord Hordak wallowed in crepuscularity. Some hours ago, the wind had ravaged a major powerline, bereaving barracks and factory units of electricity. Generators sputtered here and there, barely audible over the gale, supplying scant sustenance into the major arteries. Stormlanterns and torches

replaced some of the lamps. In the occasional window, a simple candle flickered, echoing a time long gone…

In one dormitory, such a stump sat on a scratchy windowsill, dribbling tallow of suspicious origin onto the floor and spreading a noxious stench across the chamber. A masked woman, shadows lazily coiling and undulating around her, sat in a rickety chair by the guttering light. Fingers steepled, she gazed into the goggles of a gaggle of children bundled in blankets against the unseasonal chill. Some crouched on the floor by a rusting stove, some upon their bunk beds, all keen to reach the sallow orb of the single source of illumination.

"Now, my children, hark and heed," the woman drawled. "For tonight, Old Mother Weaver will tell you a tale of madness and mayhem. However, not one of the Demon Princess of Bright Moon, but of the last monarch of the Scorpioni and the draugr of Barrowmuir."

Some in her audience blinked owlishly. "What's a draugr?" one small boy piped up from the sanctuary of his blanket. "Or Barrowmuir?"

"Patience, my young soldiers. It would not be a tale of terror, if I spoiled it, yes?" Shadow Weaver shook a scolding finger at the child. "Anyway… Many a decade ago--some reckon five-score or more--a young descendant of the royal lineage had ascended to the throne of the Scorpion Kingdom. Long-lived as they were, a full century of ravaging reign was scarcely unusual. King Scorpio he was called, a man selectively superstitious and already teetering on the brink of madness. He disdained the beliefs of the common folk, but obsessed over his own occult tomes and nigh-

on everything his augurs whispered to him in draped cabinets. This poetic prophecy I recited--thus his most trusted soothsayer once spake to him."

Her tone grimmed then. "And lest we forget the passing of tides, let us all repeat the glorious name of the dominion now flourishing upon the ruins of that vile nest of corruption!"

"The Fright Zone!" the children chorused as one, perking up from their positions to sketch a salute to the glory of the Horde.

"Good, good. It seems I shall not need to *remind* anyone tonight…" She leaned back in the seat, relaxing. The momentarily strained bearings of the cadets eased as well, one sinking back to lie upon a mattress sporting the softness of a brick in a sock. One woven of the thinnest, coarsest of threads available.

Shadow Weaver fished out a slim, age-yellowed notebook from the folds of her dress, cracked it open, and continued the story. "Many a summer and winter rolled by after this divination. The King scrutinized the hues of each dawn and dusk for specific shades of redness, falling further into his compulsion over signs and omens-"

At that point, the witch stood up, one hand massaging her backside as she frowned at the chair, possibly even *less* comfortable than the mattress that could have been utilized in the construction of a sturdy floor. She extended clawed fingers towards a cadet hugging a lumpy pillow. Glum-faced, the child

relinquished the treasured morsel of comfort, and she sat down anew.

"Hmh. Now, where was I… Nigh-on each week his minions claimed the sky had bled during a half-hearted rubescence and that this *sanguine savior* of his kingdom would arrive anon. After some time, disappointment piling upon vexation, the King ordered the soothsayer beheaded and quartered for his false presages. As the spiked body parts rotted upon the ramparts of Horror Hall, plump corpse-flies buzzing in the baking air, he swore to deliver the same fate unto every deceiver blighting his court. At that, some of his augurs fled in panic, some he slaughtered in his seething rage. For that rage fed his insanity and vice versa. A kingdom without a wise, temperate leader will become yet another oppressor amid the Princesses' savage supremacy."

A duo of older girls upon an upper bunk shared a glance, but decided to refrain from commenting. The witch immersed into her narration, and the walls of the chamber seemed to dissolve in the imaginations of the cadets. Instead of concrete and scratched metal, the ruins of the old citadel uncrumbled, abounding with life and luxury…

Days accumulated into months and further into years in the Scorpion Kingdom. The impetuous King strove to forget the prophecy which had preoccupied him so much. Then, a peculiar autumn arrived, riddled with waves of unseasonal chill amid a hurlyburly of storms. Glory for his kingdom he sought with twice the earlier vigor, waging wars beyond the Whispering Woods. A futile effort, for scarce sorcerers possessed he, their power weak against the elemental magic of the Princesses. The Black Garnet had stood lifeless for a generation or two now, nobody in the royal line capable of channeling its puissance.

One night, another tempest rampaged through the dominion. The King tossed and turned in his bed, haunted by nightmares. The glass panes of his windows jingled, the wind having blown the shutters open, screeching through odd hollows and cloisters of the palace…

Then, he jerked awake, half-delirious from the ill dreams. A sallow, withered shape loomed over him, its pallid eyes gleaming from dark, sunken pits. A bony hand was grasping his arm, as if about to pull him into the tenebrous abysses of the netherworld.

The monarch recoiled, yet finally through the torpor recognized the figure. Not a specter, but an elderly manservant that collected nightsoil in the small hours of the morn. Now furious, he seized the intruder by the throat. How dare such an insignificant worm lay its filthy fingers on the King himself? Bellowing for his retainers, he was about to snap the head of the poor bastard clean off with his pincers.

"Please, sire, look outside, an' save this wretched ol' man's life!' the servant blabbered, terrified, pointing at the grand windows through which wan stormlight pooled into the room.

Scarcely about to humor such a lowly groveler's request, something yet made the King glance outwith. Jaw dropping, he flung the servant aside, and ran to the balcony. Wrenching the door off its hinges, he juddered to a halt at the railing, chest heaving as he stared at the vista.

Lit by three moons, a lurid red trail was smeared across the lower skies, beneath the sparse, raggedy clouds herded by stormwinds. Extending towards the eastern horizon, the blasts were fast tearing it apart. Making it appear as if something had slashed a garish gash into the very tapestry of existence, the wound bleeding messily upon the sleeping demesne…

For once, the King may have comprehended the rotten crop of his rashness. Naught akin to the gloamings he had brooded over, he no longer could consult the soothsayer for further advice on the omen. He nevertheless commanded the entire court awake. A search party had to be dispatched anon, as it appeared the sanguine path--now evaporated--might *lead* somewhither.

The fates favored not the monarch further that night. One mortal man's bluster against the furor of the heavens bore no fruit, and the seekers could embark upon their quest only several days later. They interrogated peasants, and endeavored to pinpoint any physical signs the phenomenon might have left behind. This was to no avail. Most common folk had either huddled around peat fires against the chill, or slept through the tempest, few daring to even peek outside. For it was told amid the countryfolk that on such forbidding nights, the Wild Hunt of the Old Gods rode across the lands with the One-Eyed Frost-Hag at the helm, devouring the souls of any erring on their path.

And whither the ruddy route seemed to steer… Few ventured onto the eastern marshes gradually transforming into the foothills and wild wealds of the Dryl mountains. Even some of the King's closest retainers--of his very Scorpioni kin--dreaded the vast, uninhabited borderlands. In the faintest of whispers they might name the rime-wights said to inhabit the ancient barrows bespeckling the highland moors. Ought someone disturb their

peace, the entire lineage of such a trespasser would fall into ruin...

This frustrated the King to no end. These legends he considered utter balderdash, and that demesne might have provided resources untold for his budding war industry. However, rallying miners or soldiers to establish outposts could be accomplished with neither threats nor rewards, as these hearth-tales sat in the very backbones of his subjects.

At that point, the monarch had to direct his attention to the warfront. His lines were being shoved back battle after battle, the losses becoming unbearable. And as nothing befell over the next smattering of weeks, no savior strutting forth from the terminus of that trail, he had to depart the lush comforts of his citadel and fare in person to confront the failing infantry.

Then… Around the return of the King and the recommencement of attacks against the forces of the Princesses, something betid. Weird reports began trickling in from peasant hamlets dotting the borders. Livestock had vanished from pastures and enclosures during the murk of beclouded nights, depriving the overtaxed farmers and shepherds even further of necessities. Some of those animals had later been found altogether too far from their erstwhile homes, barely recognizable from a mangled bell or a scrap of dyed hide. The reason for their deaths could not be resolved in most cases, as scavengers had already discovered the carcasses, pecking and dragging away the evidence.

Nonetheless, a few accounts mentioned deep parallel marks gouged into larger bones--as if those of immense, keen claws. One note scribbled as an afterthought mentioned a set of strange

prints descried in the damp earth close to the remains of a larger milk-deer. Scrabbling scavengers had smeared most, however the ground had preserved a few impressions of human-shaped soles with beclawed toes.

In the gathering of his council, the King huffed and roared at his retainers and advisors not to squander his time with trivialities. Instead, they ought to mash their minds together and concentrate on turning the tide of the war. Treasure untold awaited in the kingdoms of the haughty Princesses, soon to flow through the pincers of them all! Most eyes gleamed with greed at this. One retainer not entirely blinded by the promises still attempted to reason with the King.

"But sire, the peasants are asking for aid. Soldiers or seasoned hunters to guard them and track down whatever is snatching their livestock. Some are afraid to remain in the pastures after dark."

"Well, tell them to lock their damned cattle in come twilight!" the King grumbled. "Much ado about naught, as usual for those niding nitwits. Clawmarks. Bah. Some hungry lizard steals a few eggs and ruffles some henfeathers, the rumormill spins, and eftsoons a horde of man-eating demons is rumored to stalk the night."

Thus the argument waned, the council inviting in an assemblage of alchemists and engineers instead. For *technology* had to provide the answer to subduing the supremacy of those sodden sorcerers…

Reports about livestock disappearances halved thereafter, then thirded, and the King refused to pay heed to the rest. Mayhap the rogue lizard had been caught, and now ornamented the wardrobe of some landholder.

Some months passed in relative quietude. Then…a more foreboding surge occurred. Some councilmembers pleaded for the King to listen, as the reports no longer concerned mere beasts of the pasture. Peasants had commenced disappearing on those same areas, all after evenfall. Solely a handful out of the alarming number of missing persons had been found. All slaughtered in a grisly manner, kilometers away from their crofts. It was reasoned that suicides or runaways to avoid conscription could not explicate the numbers.

"Sire, this isn't…if it's the same creature or a pack thereof- It isn't just some mindless, hungry hog," a laird who had journeyed to the capital to plead with the King exhaled, visibly blanched as he wiped sweat off his brow. "It's been striking on an enormous area along the northern border and a swathe of the eastern territory. And the livestock ere this… A pregnant milk-deer isn't something to just…*drag away*. One'd need immense strength and counter-weight to achieve that. But what's happing now… It's a sentient being that *plans*."

"Hrhmf. Eastern territory, you say?" the King grunted, leaning his cheek against a pincer.

"Aye, milord," the laird gulped. "There's this hamlet on the north-eastern crescent. Two armed hunters had taken unto themselves to patrol the outskirts of the habitat, as this location had suffered greater losses than most. *Armed*, sire, with spears and seaxes!

Come the morn, neither returned home. Their wives organized a search party anon, and half a sennight later… Close to a marsh, their remains were uncovered. But not just sprawling on the heath. Milord, they'd been…impaled by their own spears struck to the ground! Two burly men in their prime! Ribcages cracked open, longbones exposed and…sire, slashed with what looked like claws!"

The man stuttered now, more sweat beading upon his temples. "Th- their heads were missing. A scavenger crow doesn't just pluck one off a spearhead and flap away with it, sire. Whoever killed them, took them along."

* * *

At that point, Shadow Weaver had to halt her narration. A small wisp of a girl, barely visible beneath her blanket, was holding an arm aloft.

"Yes, young Trebuchetina. What is it?"

"What's…impaling?" she mumbled into a corner of the fabric.

"Ahhh, now that serves as a fine, educational question. It is an archaic method of killing and torture. A sharpened stake is driven into the body through the fork of the legs, following natural orifices, and hoisted aloft. The person stays suspended in mid-air, sometimes remaining alive for days if no vital organs are pierced."

“Wow, cool!” another girl in the back row piped up. The inquisitive one shuddered instead, and hid entirely underneath the covering with a small whimper.

“If there are no more queries, let us continue…”

* * *

The King racked his brain, wondering if the betidings could anyhow pertain to that fateful stormnight. But no…his savior was supposed to stride forth as a lofty figure akin to Death himself, were they not? Scarcely sembling a murderous marauder lurking in the woods… And perhaps that was the crux of it. A filthy band of traitors--doubtless deserters from the battlefields--now endeavored to exact vengeance on his dominion. Pathetic.

In the end, the King agreed to allocate a small retinue of experienced hunters armed with rifles to patrol the heaviest-hit area and map the sites of casualties. Trackhounds and firearms ought to take care of anything, man or beast alike. Besides, the company was led by one of his kinsmen, an eager pursuer of forest game. A game-changer, so to say. Chuckling to his own jest, the King signed the order, expecting everything to be over in less than a fortnight.

However, about a week later he had to reconsider his gleeful notions of endgame. The entire company had been found staked to their bayoneted rifles akin to a morbid barbecue. The ribcages

of most had been slashed open as if their bones possessed the consistency of jelly, furthermore beheaded and missing their skulls. One of the victims had nevertheless been alive at the moment of discovery. Perhaps the approaching dawn had been their salvation, perhaps not, for they perished to their wounds in a nearby village later that same day. Brows knitted in ire, the King hearkened to the account of yet another landholder and the subsequent disappearances further north.

"No' much wit left in the dyin' hunter," the landholder sighed. "We tried questionin' 'em about whodunnit, but they just kept screamin' about a…*draugr*. How this monster started tearin' the flesh o' their kith with its fangs, eatin' 'em alive an' sucking blood from the stumps o' severed necks. And how they could still see its face, even though their eyes had been gouged out."

The King massaged his temples in vexation. "What is this… draugr? Some mythical moor-mongrel no doubt? I have never bothered with such fatuitous folderol."

The reporter twitched as if the King had uttered blasphemy. "Well, aye. Sire kens the barrowlands to the east? It-"

"Urgh. Save me the folklore lecture." The King bared his teeth in a snarl. "Were you able to squeeze anything *reasonable* out of this hunter? *Anything* that could be damn well used in identifying the culprit? So it is not a witless beast. What about its cronies? I presume you will not strive to convince me that a single brute wrought havoc on an armed band of five, plus their hounds?"

"Well, sire…" the landholder coughed. "The dyin' didn't mention any others. But that's the form o' a draugr, that it's *huge*. No' just tall or burly, but a *giant* o' a wight wi' the brawn o' ten bears. We checked the rifles too, an' what remained o' the bandoliers. About half of their bullets had been shot or elsewise were missin'. Whatever it is, fire didn't stop it."

"One giant of a wight…" the monarch muttered. "Aught, *aught* else? What about the hounds?"

"No' a trace o' 'em, sire. As for other details… Well, they kept wailing summat about the fires o' hell blazing in the beast's gaze. Like 'twas there to consume 'em for their sins."

The King flinched at that, a cold shiver wriggling down his spine. It… It could not be, could it? "This…draugr-creature. Describe it to me. The generic specimen."

The landholder shrugged, however ready to deliver the scorned folklore lecture. "'Tis…a walking corpse, sire. Said to rise from its burial mound o' yore, ought summat disturb its peace or treasure. Usually clad in rags, but no' skeletal as it gets nourishment from th' living it devours. Regeneratin', like. Stinks o' rottin' flesh, always boastin' uncanny strength, and have summat akin to a skull for a face. Pale as bleached bone, sunken eyes, maw a death-grin o' sharp teeth, an' the ilk."

Another chill coursed through the King's body, grasping his heartstrings. By the Gods! *Donning the demeanor of Death, glare-glows his grim glower…* This…this could no longer be regarded as

a coincidence. If only he had spared that sordid soothsayer… He sprung up, bellowing a bidding to the attendees and retainers scattered around the throne room.

"I want every hunter, tracker, and trapper in the kingdom to forseek this creature, and deliver it unto me *alive*! Whosoever succeeds in this, shall be handsomely rewarded for their deed!"

The command soon soared to the farthest corners of the kingdom with swift raven-wings. The eyes of many a war-taxed peasant gleamed with hope and hunger. However, the King had omitted the depiction matching a draugr from the official announcement, painting it with vaguer brush-strokes to gain actual traction. Perchance the Princesses had cursed someone into a werwulf, perchance an escapee from the dreary depths of the Whispering Woods had strayed too close to the hamlets. Had the simple folk suspected dealing with anything associated with the eastern moors, they might never have ventured into the wilderness environing the borderland settlements.

As for that notorious location itself… Scarce a seeker still wended their way towards the foothills of the Dryllian orogeny. And whoever did thus, never returned.

The mandate proved both farce and fortune. All kinds of creatures were hauled into Horror Hall, most of them ordinary animals from large hounds and bats to a runty sandworm dragged thither from the Crimson Wastes. When a stuffed, motheaten direwolf on wheels was carted in, the King nigh-on decreed the deliverer executed for their audacity. Nevertheless, this time the frail threads of his patience snapped not, for such a public episode might have snuffed out the effort.

On the other hand, more sightings of what must have been the actual beast crept in. Disappearances never ceased, but merely shifted towards the eastern areas. Glimpses of blood-red eyes burning in the murk, of a hulking black shape grinning akin to the Grim Reaper, of a sweep of dark, raggedy wings… Someone had emptied an entire bandolier of bullets into the nocturnal underbrush, merely to find them scattered around on the ground come the morrow, as if they had ricocheted off the hide of something uncanny. Another had heard a low growl echoing across the fields, a third had caught a whiff of some noxious, inexplicable reek, and someone else had sighted a massive shape wading through dark waters neath a moon plunging out of the clouds… Sometimes a peculiar whirring sound had been perceived, akin to a hive of hornets on the move whilst no insects were present.

Then, another victim still alive was recovered. Even if he survived scant hours with a cracked ribcage and internal damage from the impaling, he confirmed what the erst dying had howled during their last moments. A draugr of horrendous proportions, boasting fangs that could crunch through bone and carapace alike, maw and eyes aflame with an infernal glow... Its thirst for blood was insatiable, but through the obscene slurps and sucking sounds the perishing person swore he had heard the beast *sing* to itself. A language unknown, undulating, transforming into a guttural hum as it had masticated on the still beating heart of another villager.

Odd, fragmented details the perishing preserved. Flashes of utterly lucid moments amid chaos and primal horror, the rest a blur… The King brooded over it all. Whence had the creature emerged? How had it overcome an amassment of armed archers and the ilk? How did it move, for it switched terrains too swiftly for aught landborne, and never left a proper trail of odor behind even if it allegedly stank worse than a morgue on a hot day? Naught such could the victim explain. He inhaled his last breath

and remained to stare with empty sockets at the ceiling of the blackhouse whereinto he had been carried.

The King consulted his remaining augurs over the matter, and their readings produced mostly veiled visions of the future. In one particular they however agreed: something shadowy bode in the east, soaked in grue and exhaling an aura of ancient destruction. And *wings* they beheld. No soothsayer could determine what kind, merely that they spread across the welkins, gargantuan and portentous, obscuring the moons of Etheria. Elsewise, it seemed the monarch had to unravel this riddle entangled in an enigma on his own.

The King yet paid heed to the meager hints, as the plausibility of the alleged draugr having adopted the secluded moors or forests as its base increased daily. A clever move… Now, he sat upon his throne, ill-humored, scowling at a sketch a royal painter had produced based on a myriad of descriptions. A ludicrous conglomeration of features, the all-too-elongated creature envisioned possessed two sets of massive vespine wings, an armored body, and claws akin to scythes. Everything was topped with a befanged skull, eyes aglow with a sanguine light and growth of some persuasion sprouting from the scalp. In one hand, it bore an impaling stave.

Preposterous. There had to be a less…extravagant explanation to all this.

"Let us commence anew. We wit not whether it wields actual wings. Forsooth, it hunts in the cover of beclouded nights, yet nobody has descried it aloft."

Could that…that sky-path somehow pertain to this dilemma of flight? He had mulled over it again and afresh over the fleeting months. Man-bearing flying machines were feasible in theory, even if his engineers had thus far managed to produce mere miniatures. Fragmented annals recorded that such devices might have existed upon Etheria in the far-flung past, but the knowhow had been lost. The First Ones they had called this vanished civilization…

Among other marvels, that culture had been rumored to master technology that could unfold gateways into other realms. Mayhap what the monarch now chased had emerged from some vast unknown beyond the asteroid belt of Etheria, plummeting into the atmosphere of the planet through such a portal. An otherworldly bringer of light and glory, in the illusory guise of a peril…

After several discarded papers and an audible brawl over the portrayal, the King frowned at a fresh drawing. This depicted something more humanoid, clad in a cloak and dark-hued armor, astride a…machine. The latter resembled an unholy offspring of a giant bat and a motorized bicycle. One of his engineers might have produced a more sensible impression, but this…perhaps the right direction. Instead of staves, the fiend dangled a sack of severed heads from one claw akin to a trophy.

At that point, a mapper that had been struggling with the sightings and disappearances for some time seemed to have completed their chart. With a flourish, they unrolled it open afore the King, and pointed at the markers. The monarch grunted, having already expected the outcome: a garish congestion of red dots akin to ticks swollen with blood by the eastern marshes. Exactly whither the sanguine trail in the sky had wended its way… If a flying vessel of some persuasion had crash-landed

thereabouts, that wilderness would provide countless hidey-holes for something even the magnitude of a mansion. Half submerged into a bog, enshrouded by the ever-present mists, it might sit there for the next five centuries untouched, unless *someone* acted. *Now.*

He squinted at the lands adjacent to the Dryllian border. This representation treated them akin to terra incognita, sans names and distinct features. More accurate maps were required, even if he and his librarians were obliged to peruse every single dusty tome in the royal collections. The cycle of a full year had closed since the sighting of the wound in the heavens. In spite of the hunt, the assailings were beginning to cause riots amid the peasants, and abandonments of homesteads as families sought to move inland.

Autumn was descending, and the common folk waxed evermore superstitious about deuced grumkins and snarks as the *veil thinned*. It appeared he would need to hijack the Wild Hunt and steal the reins from the Frost-Hag, together with a trusted cadre who did not soil themselves soggy at the mere notion of soil boggy.

Furthermore…he required *bait* to lure the draugr into his trap.

End Notes

Thank you for reading! Please leave a comment below and let me know what you think of the story.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!